

Valsartan Plus

Film Coated Tablets



Composition:

Each Valsartan Plus 80/12.5 Film Coated Tablet contains:

Valsartan 80 mg, Hydrochlorothiazide 12.5 mg.

Each Valsartan Plus 160/12.5 Film Coated Tablet contains:

Valsartan 160 mg, Hydrochlorothiazide 12.5 mg.

Each Valsartan Plus 160/25 Film Coated Tablet contains:

Valsartan 160 mg, Hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg.

Mechanism of Action:

Valsartan Plus is a combination of Valsartan and Hydrochlorothiazide.

- Valsartan is an angiotensin II receptor blocker (ARBs). It works by blocking the effect of angiotensin II on its AT₁ receptors, as a result, blood vessels relax, and blood pressure decreases.

- Hydrochlorothiazide belongs to the thiazide diuretics. Thiazides act by inhibiting the sodium/chlorine transporter in the distal convoluted renal tubules, directly increasing the excretion of sodium and chloride to an approximately equal extent, and indirectly increasing the excretion of potassium in the urine and hypokalemia. The use of Valsartan tends to reverse the potassium loss associated with these diuretics.

Pharmacokinetics:

Valsartan: After giving Valsartan orally, it reaches the plasma concentration peak after 2-4 hours, with a bioavailability of about 23%. Valsartan is highly bound to serum proteins (94–97)%, mainly serum albumin. Valsartan is not bio-transformed to a high extent (less than 20% of the administered dose undergoes hepatic metabolism). Most of it is excreted through bile in the feces (about 83% of the dose) and renally in urine (about 13% of the dose), mainly as an unchanged drug.

Hydrochlorothiazide: Hydrochlorothiazide is rapidly absorbed, and the absolute bioavailability of hydrochlorothiazide is 70% after oral administration. Hydrochlorothiazide is bound to serum proteins (40–70)%, mainly serum albumin. It also accumulates in erythrocytes at approximately 3 times the level in plasma. Hydrochlorothiazide is eliminated predominantly as an unchanged drug.

Indications:

Valsartan Plus is indicated for the treatment of hypertension:

- In patients whose hypertension is not controlled by monotherapy.
- As an initial treatment in patients who may need multiple medications to control their blood pressure.

Contraindications:

- Hypersensitivity to any component of Valsartan Plus.
- Severe hepatic impairment, biliary cirrhosis and cholestasis.
- Severe renal impairment (creatinine clearance <30 ml/min), anuria.
- Refractory hypokalaemia, hyponatremia, hypercalcemia, and symptomatic hyperuricemia.

Warnings & Precautions:

- Warns with all antihypertensive therapy, symptomatic hypotension may occur in some patients.
- Valsartan Plus should not be used to treat hypertension in patients

with unilateral or bilateral renal artery stenosis or stenosis of the artery to a solitary kidney.

- Evaluation of patients with heart failure or post-myocardial infarction should always include assessment of renal function.
- Patients with primary hyperaldosteronism should not be treated with Valsartan Plus as their renin-angiotensin system is not activated.
- In patients with mild to moderate hepatic impairment without cholestasis, Valsartan Plus should be used with caution.
- Thiazide diuretics can exacerbate or activate systemic lupus erythematosus.
- Thiazide diuretics may alter glucose tolerance and raise serum cholesterol levels, triglycerides and uric acid levels.
- If photosensitivity reaction occurs during treatment, it is recommended to stop the treatment.
- Valsartan Plus should be immediately discontinued in patients who develop angioedema, and Valsartan Plus should not be re-administered.

Pregnancy & Lactation:

Pregnancy: Pregnancy Category D. Valsartan Plus is contraindicated in pregnancy.

When pregnancy is diagnosed, treatment with Valsartan Plus should be stopped immediately.

Lactation: Valsartan Plus is not recommended and alternative treatments with better-established safety profiles during breastfeeding are preferable.

Driving & Using Machines:

No studies have been performed on the effects on the ability to drive and use machines. When driving vehicles or operating machinery, the occasional possibility of dizziness or fatigue should be taken into account.

Drug Interactions:

Alcohol, barbiturates, and narcotics: Orthostatic hypotension may occur with concomitant administration with thiazides.

Antidiabetic drugs: Dosage adjustment of the Antidiabetic drug may be required.

Other antihypertensive drugs: Increases the antihypertensive effect of Valsartan plus.

Cholestyramine and colestipol: These drugs significantly reduce the absorption of hydrochlorothiazide.

Corticosteroids: Intensified electrolyte depletion, particularly hypokalemia.

Lithium: Should not generally be given with diuretics. Diuretic agents reduce the renal clearance of lithium and add a high risk of lithium toxicity.

NSAIDs: Concomitant use with Valsartan plus may increase the risk of renal impairment and reduce the diuretic and antihypertensive effects. Patients should be closely monitored to determine if the desired diuretic and antihypertensive effect has been obtained.

Aliskiren: The concomitant use with Valsartan Plus is contraindicated in patients with diabetes mellitus or renal impairment (GFR <60 ml/min/1.73 m²).

Side Effects:

Some side effects may appear when using Valsartan Plus, may

include hypotension, headache, dizziness, cough, diarrhea, rhinitis, sinusitis, nausea, pharyngitis, edema, and arthralgia.

Rarely allergic reaction and asthenia, palpitation, constipation, dry mouth, dyspepsia, back pain, muscle cramps, anxiety, insomnia, paresthesia, somnolence, dyspnea, vertigo and impotence.

Dosage & Administration:

- The recommended dose of Valsartan Plus is one tablet once daily. The dose should be adjusted according to each patient's condition.
- The clinical response to Valsartan Plus should be evaluated after initiating therapy and if blood pressure remains uncontrolled, the dose may be increased by increasing either one of the components to a maximum dose of Valsartan/Hydrochlorothiazide 320 mg/25 mg.
- Maximum antihypertensive effects are observed within 4 weeks. However, some patients may need treatment for 4-8 weeks for these effects to be noticed. This should be taken into account while adjusting the dose.

Renal impairment: No dose adjustment is required for patients with mild to moderate renal impairment (Glomerular Filtration Rate (GRF) ≥30 ml/min).

Valsartan Plus is contraindicated in patients with severe renal impairment (creatinine clearance ≤ 30 ml/min), due to the presence of hydrochlorothiazide.

Hepatic impairment: In patients with mild to moderate hepatic impairment without cholestasis the dose of Valsartan should not exceed 80 mg. No adjustment of the hydrochlorothiazide dose is required for patients with mild to moderate hepatic impairment. Valsartan Plus is contraindicated in patients with severe hepatic impairment or with biliary cirrhosis and cholestasis.

Pediatric population: Valsartan Plus is not recommended for use in children below the age of 18 years due to a lack of data on safety and efficacy.

Overdose:

Symptoms: Overdose with Valsartan may result in marked hypotension, which could lead to depressed level of consciousness, and/or shock. In addition, the following signs and symptoms may occur due to an overdose of the hydrochlorothiazide component: nausea, somnolence, hypovolaemia, and electrolyte disturbances associated with cardiac arrhythmias and muscle spasms.

Treatment: The therapeutic measures depend on the time of ingestion and the type and severity of the symptoms; stabilization of the circulatory condition is of prime importance. If hypotension occurs, the patient should be placed in a supine position and appropriate electrolytes and fluids should be administered. It is not likely that Valsartan will be eliminated by hemodialysis.

Storage:

Keep out of reach of children. Store below 30°C.

Packaging:

Each Valsartan Plus (80/12.5) - (160/12.5) - (160/25) Carton Box contains 20 Film Coated Tablets in two Alu/Alu blisters.

*A medication is a product which affects your health, and its consumption contrary to instructions is dangerous for you.
*Follow strictly the doctor's prescriptions, the method of use and the instructions of the pharmacist who sold the medication.
*The doctor and the pharmacist experts in medicine, its benefits and risks.
*Do not repeat the same prescription without consulting your doctor.
KEEP THE MEDICINES OUT OF REACH OF CHILDREN
Council of Arab Health Ministers, Union of Arab Pharmacies
Revva Pharmaceutical Industry - Syria

